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Principal Security Specialist

OFGEM

Apply before 11:55 pm on Monday 19th October 2026

ofgem

Reference number

483788

Salary

£63,443 - £86,547

Please ensure that you read the Pay and Reward information for civil service and internal colleagues before applying.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 6

Level 3

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

Cyber Regulation and Emerging Technologies

Type of role

Other

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Successful candidates may be based in any of our office locations – Cardiff, Glasgow, or London. We especially welcome applicants from Cardiff and Glasgow.

About the job

Job summary

Ofgem is Great Britain's independent energy regulator - a critical role that puts us at the forefront of cyber security, ensuring public data is safe and secure and that we set the standard for the energy industry. We're looking for a Principal Security Specialist (IT/OT) to join and lead the design, assessment, and implementation of innovative security solutions and associated guidance aimed at protecting critical systems. This work aligns with our core mission: to deliver a fair, sustainable, and secure energy future.

This is a permanent role within our Cyber Guidance & Monitoring (G&M) team, which sits within Ofgem's Cyber and Emerging Technologies Directorate. The G&M team focus on ensuring resilience is built into systems run by energy operators who control the UK's energy infrastructure. We do this as part of our role as Joint Competent Authority (JCA) for the Network and Information Systems Regulations 2018 (NIS Regulations). We provide 1-2-1 and sector-wide advice and guidance to operators throughout their security journeys, seeking to build greater collective industry resilience. We are very fortunate to be able to help influence and shape the security and resilience of a whole sector (specifically, the Downstream Gas and Electricity sector).

Job description

As an expert in the field, you'll lead high-profile security improvement projects, engaging with a wide range of internal and external stakeholders to

shape security posture, implementing best practice in line with National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC) guidance. This is a chance to be at the forefront of innovation and meaningful change, championing secure by design principles and influencing digital strategies that benefit millions. This role provides a rare opportunity to combine technical expertise with strategic leadership and it's an exciting time to join us!

At Ofgem, we offer more than just a job – we provide a supportive and flexible working environment designed to help you thrive. With hybrid working arrangements, newly refurbished offices in central London, Glasgow, or Cardiff, and a generous rewards package that includes excellent professional learning and development opportunities (including access to potential higher education funding – subject to review), you'll find everything you need to excel both professionally and personally.

For further details on the role and on our hybrid working arrangement, please read the candidate pack and other documents below.

Person specification

Please ensure you demonstrate clearly, within your supporting statement, how you meet each of the essential criteria. In the event of receiving a large number of applications, an initial sift may take place on just the lead criteria indicated in the essential criteria.

Essential Criteria:

Demonstrable experience in a leading role managing technical security risk and delivering security improvement plans within complex organisational, operational, or critical infrastructure environments. **(LEAD)**

Proven experience providing security advice, guidance, challenge, and assurance to stakeholders responsible for critical systems, business services, or infrastructure.

Experience applying security frameworks, risk management methodologies, and technical standards (e.g. NCSC CAF, NIST CSF, ISO 27001, CIS Controls, IEC/ISA 62443) to assess and improve organisational resilience.

Strong stakeholder management and communication skills, including the ability to influence decision-making and communicate complex security risks to both technical and non-technical audiences.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Seeing the Big Picture

Changing and Improving

Making Effective Decisions

Communicating and Influencing

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £63,443, Ofgem contributes £18,379 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

Ofgem can offer you a comprehensive and competitive benefits package which includes; 30 days annual leave after 2 years; Excellent training and development opportunities; The opportunity to join the generous Civil Service pension which also includes a valuable range of benefits; hybrid working (currently 1 day a week in the office but this is kept under review), flexible working hours and family friendly policies. Plus lots of other benefits including clean and bright offices based centrally, engaged networks and teams and an opportunity to contribute to our ambitious and important targets of establishing a Net Zero energy system by 2050. This exciting blend of professional challenge and personal reward identifies career opportunities at Ofgem as something to get excited about.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has

been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours and Experience.

When you press the **Apply now** button, you will be asked to complete personal details (not seen by the sift panel), your career history and qualifications.

You will then be asked to provide a 1250 word personal statement evidencing how you meet the essential skills and capabilities listed in the role profile. Please ensure you demonstrate clearly, within your supporting statement, how you meet each of the criteria listed in the role profile. In the event of receiving a large number of applications, an initial sift may take place on just the **lead criteria** indicated in the essential criteria.

The personal information we have collected from you will be shared with Cifas who will use it to prevent fraud, other unlawful or dishonest conduct, malpractice, and other seriously improper conduct. If any of these are detected, you could be refused certain services or employment. Your personal information will also be used to verify your identity. Further details of how your information will be used by us and Cifas, and your data protection rights, can be found by [\[https://www.cifas.org.uk/fpn\]](https://www.cifas.org.uk/fpn).

At Ofgem, we expect our staff to carry out their roles with honesty, fairness and openness. They should follow the Civil Service code and be free from any influence or bias. We are committed to making sure interests are recognised, declared and managed appropriately so that we can fulfil our duties as an energy regulator. Our [Conflicts of Interest policy](#) outlines the types of interests Ofgem staff must declare before onboarding, and the rules they must follow throughout employment so that we can clearly demonstrate that our decisions are not influenced by private interests.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Rob Wilkins

Email : recruitment@ofgem.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : recruitment@ofgem.gov.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. You have the right to complain if you feel there has been a breach of these Recruitment Principles.

In the first instance, you should raise the matter directly via recruitment@ofgem.gov.uk. If you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission, please visit their website.

